

Nature of Happiness

1. Subjective Experience:

Happiness is personal and unique — what makes one person happy might not work for someone else. It Varies from person to person. It depends on how we perceive our experiences.

- **Example:** Anna feels happy when she reads a book at home, but her friend Lisa finds happiness in going out to parties. Both are happy, but in their own ways.

2. Social Well-being and Mental State:

Happiness is closely tied to both mental health and social connections. Strong relationships and emotional support boost happiness, while loneliness can lower it. Our happiness is ruled by our thoughts.

- **Example:** Prateek feels happy and secure when he spends time with his family and friends. However, when he isolates himself for too long, his mood drops.

3. Short-Term vs. Long-Term Happiness:

Happiness can be:

- Short-term (pleasure-based): Immediate, momentary joys.
- Long-term (meaning-based): Deeper fulfilment from purpose and growth.
- **Example:** Eating ice cream brings Emily short-term happiness, but working hard to open her own bakery gives her long-term happiness by fulfilling her dreams.

4. Internal and External Factors:

Happiness comes from both inside and outside:

- Internal: Mindset, gratitude, personal values.
- External: Money, achievements, social status.
- **Example:** Mike's promotion at work (external) makes him happy, but his daily practice of meditation (internal) keeps him calm and positive.

5. Linked to Personal Growth:

True happiness often comes from learning, evolving, and achieving goals. When people grow mentally, emotionally, or skillfully, they experience a sense of satisfaction. Updating oneself with good skills to achieve a better life.

- **Example:** Diksha feels proud and happy after mastering a new language, as it reflects her hard work and self-improvement.

6. Cultural and Social Influence:

Happiness is also shaped by culture and society. Different cultures define happiness differently — some value individual success, while others focus on community well-being.

- **Example:** In the U.S., happiness might be linked to personal achievements, while in Japan, it could be tied to harmony within family and community.

7. Emotions:

Happiness is not just about feeling good all the time. It's about managing all emotions — including sadness or anger — in a healthy way, leading to emotional balance.

- **Example:** Aditi had a tough day at work but practices gratitude by focusing on the positive things in his life, keeping his happiness steady despite challenges.